

Linn: Mist & Iron

Raids, Rivers, and Oathbinding (Fate's Edge v0.1)

A culture-focused module for coastal raids, river thrusts, oath-law, and seasonal expeditions by the Linns—seafarers of the north who strike the Violet Steppe littoral, run the Yloka up into the Abderrian Sea and Mistlands, and range as far south as Theona in the Dolmis. Built to slot into Amaranthine Sea, Political Intrigue, Wilderness, and Caravans using core Fate's Edge procedures (Position/DV, SB, timers, Strings, Favor/Leverage/Exposure).

Design Goals

- **Oath before oar.** Social bonds, boasts, and blood-silver shape play as much as blades.
- **Raider–trader parity.** Raids, mercenary service, and escort trade are equally supported.
- **Seamless integration.** Uses existing chase/ship rules, faction timers, and currencies—no new dice math.
- **Low bookkeeping.** Crew, ship, season wheel, and 2–3 visible timers per scenario.

Linn: Mist & Iron - The First Year (Quickstart) |>m2.5cm|>m3cm|>m4cm|>m3.5cm|

gray!20 **Season Key Activities Mechanical Focus Sample Score**

Winter Hearth/Thing Rest, repair, socialize, attend Thing moots

- Resolve Feuds with Blood-Silver
- Swear/fulfill Oaths
- Advance Repute through deeds

Thing Moot: Settle disputes, gain winter land, swear new oaths

Spring Muster Prepare ships, gather crews, plan summer activities

- Ship repairs/upgrades
- Crew coordination rolls
- Plan expedition objectives

Scout Mission: Gather intelligence on threats/locations for summer

Summer Raids Active expeditions, trading, warfare

- Coastal Raid (Plunder/Blood-Price timers)
- River Strike (Pursuit/Current timers)
- Combat encounters
- Weather/Ice hazards

Coastal Raid: Plunder a settlement while evading pursuit
Autumn Trade/Settling Profit from summer deeds, settle accounts

- Escort/Trade (Market procedures)
- Saga Reputation gains
- Social maneuvering at Thing
- Plan for winter

Escort Mission: Protect trade goods while navigating hazards

Core Quickstart Rules Summary |>m3cm|>m5cm|>m5cm|

gray!20 **System Quick Rule Key Dice**

Crew Tracks Repute [6]: Fame/standing

Feud [4]: Active quarrels

Exposure [6]: Foreign attention DV 2-5

Position: Dominant/Controlled/Desperate

Re-roll 1 success/failure

Ship Actions Navigate (DV 2-5)

Board & Brace (DV 3-5)

Chase (Sea/River) (DV 2-5) Ship Tags modify DVs

Weather/Ice Matrix [4-6]

Oaths & Saga Oath Ledger: Favors owed/held

Break Oath: Repute -1, Feud +1

Saga Reputation [6]: Local → Regional → Legendary Saga Points for epic deeds

Position/Social benefits by tier

Complications Mist & Iron SB Menu (1-4 SB)

Weather/Ice hazards

Fen Corruption timer Story Beats drive narrative

Environmental timers

1 Linn Crew/Clan Sheet (Template)

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[CLAN / CREW NAME]

Aett (home seat): _____ Thing Affiliation: _____

Strings (2–3): winter harbor • river-right • trade oath • feud settlement • warding chant •
 pilot's stone

Tags (2–4): Oathbound • Riverwise • Ice-Trained • Reaver-Known • Hospitable • Law-Strict • Skald-Loud • Wolf-Banner

Tracks:

- Repute [6] (standing among Linn and neighbors)
- Feud [4] (active quarrel; on fill → blood-price owed or war)
- Exposure [6] (to foreign powers; for non-Linn venues)

Oath Ledger: favors owed/held (name + what; acts like Favor/Leverage within Linn spheres)

Notables: steersman • war-leader • speaker • skald • shipwright

Repute [6]: Tick up for kept oaths, fair trade, valor; tick down for oath-breaking, cowardice, or sacrilege. High Repute grants Audience: Respectful at thing; low invites Audience: Skeptical.

Feud [4]: Name the counterparty. Ticks on insult, theft, or harm; clear by blood-silver, ordeal, or deed.

2 Ship Sheet (Longhulls & Rivercraft)

Pick a hull and 3–4 tags.

Longhull (raider): shallow draft, fast oars, beachable.

Broadshore (cargo): higher freeboard, stout frames, slower oars.

River-spear (cutter): light, narrow, collapsible mast for weirs.

Ship Tags (choose 3–4)

- Shallow Draft — River rapids Drive/Handle DV –1; cross bars, weirs.
- Beaching Hull — Land/sail from beaches; Disengage gains Position +1 at surf.
- Ice-Ready — In thaw/freeze scenes, first Condition +1 is ignored.
- Mistwise — In fog/gares, Navigate DV –1; Ambush at Sea starts one Position higher.
- River-Runner — Row Upstream DV –1; portage checks Position +1.
- Wolf-Boarding Gear — Board & Brace DV –1; entangling hooks/ropes.
- High Shields — +1 die defending vs arrows/sling; on 1: Side-Slip penalty (windage) applies.
- Skald-Drum — Once/score gain Audience: Fierce aboard; can rally morale.
- Pilots' Stones — Hidden cairn-marks; once/score Navigate Position +1 in shoals.

Roles (choose at table)

Steersman (helm), War-Leader (boarding/assault), Speaker (parley), Skald (morale/saga), Shorehand (portage/repairs), Lookout (weather/ice).

3 Season Wheel & Theaters

Spring Muster → Summer Raids → Autumn Trade/Settling → Winter Hearth/Thing.

At each transition:

- Advance Politics (Mandate/Crisis) for coastal powers.
- Roll Weather/Ice [4–6] for the theater in play (coast, river, mistland).
- Offer Oath Opportunities (escort, feud settlement, shrine warding).

Theaters

- Coast (Abderrian/Mistlands): cliffs, skerries, tide races, fog.
- River (Yloka): bars, rapids, weirs, toll-fords, riverside towns.
- Dolmis Reach (south): broader seas, warmer storms, foreign courts.

4 Score Types & Procedures

Pick approach (Deceit • Speed • Shock • Parley) → set Position/DV from venue/tags → roll.

4.1 Coastal Raid (Objective: Plunder / Message / Prisoner)

Timers: Alarm [4–6], Plunder [6–8], Ship Damage [4], Blood-Price [4].

Entry: surf landing, hidden cove, tide gate, harbor ruse.

On 1s: GM spends SB → alarm bells, hidden shoal, torch-chain across channel, watch-tower signal.

Resolution: When Plunder fills, choose coin or Strings (hostage pledge, toll writ, seasonal tithe).
If Blood-Price fills, mark Feud +1 or pay blood-silver (Favor loss or obligation timer).

4.2 River Strike (Objective: Tollhouse / Weir / Rival Barge)

Timers: Current [4], Pursuit [6], Sentries [4], Plunder/Terms [6].

Position tweaks: River-Runner/Shallow Draft help; crosswinds/hail hurt.

On 1s: weir gets raised, arrows from reed-blind, boom-chain snaps at wrong time.

4.3 Escort/Trade (Objective: Profit / Standing)

Use Market from Amaranthine/Caravans; add Linn perks:

- Thing Tokens (oath-markers) count as String once/session in Linn venues.
- Skald-Drum can convert Audience: Warm → Favor (narrow) once/score with a saga.

4.4 Thing Moot (Objective: Law / Settlement)

Venue: ring of stones, winter hall.

Moves: Oath-Swear (commit under penalty), Wager Wyrd (ordeal by feat), Blood-Silver (compensation roll), Witness the Saga (Skald stakes a truth).

Outcomes: resolve Feud, write Oath to ledger (acts as durable String), assign winter land or river-right.

5 Oaths, Blood-Silver, & Repute

- **Oath (currency):** Inside Linn spheres, treat Oath Ledger entries as Favor/Leverage equivalents; breaking one ticks Repute -1 and creates Feud +1.
- **Blood-Silver (settlement):** Pay with coin, hostage-string, or deed. Roll Petition/Broker vs DV 2-4 (standing, witnesses, hurt). On hit, reduce Feud -2; on partial, -1; on miss, counter-oath demanded.
- **Boasts & Sagas:** A public boast creates Audience: Expectant; fulfill it to gain Repute +1, fail and mark Exposure or Feud.

6 Sea & River Procedures

6.1 DV Ladders

- **Chase (Sea):** DV 2 reach • 3 skerries • 4 reef line • 5 storm eddies.
- **Chase (River):** DV 2 open • 3 bars • 4 rapids • 5 weirs/locks.
- **Board & Brace:** DV 3-5 (tags: Wolf-Boarding Gear lowers DV).

6.2 Weather/Ice Matrix [4-6]

Advance on 1s or fiction:

- **Fog/Mist:** sight Position -1; Mistwise cancels. On 1, Pursuit +1 (lost bearings).
- **Squall/Hail:** ranged actions -1 die; on 1, Condition +1 (sails/rig).
- **Ice/Floe:** Navigate DV +1; on 1, choose Delay (Distance stalls) or Keel-Scuff (Condition +1).

6.3 Portage & Weirs

Treat as Cross Hazard (Body+Tactics/Craft) DV 3-5; River-Runner/Shallow Draft grant Position +1. On 1, Oarline snaps or Axle-sled breaks.

6.4 Mist & Iron SB (GM menu)

- Hidden Shoal: sudden ground; Ship Damage +1 unless Position was high.
- Tower Fire: beacon lit; Pursuit +1 and Alarm +1.
- Oarline Breaks: lose Position; repair or fight short-handed.
- Witness at Cliff: an enemy skiff sees; Exposure +1 (foreign) or Feud +1 (Linn).
- Saga Twisted: rumor flips an Audience tag against you.

7 Linn Culture Tools (portrayal guidance)

- Emphasize law and reciprocity (oaths, blood-silver, witness) over caricature.
- Show plural livelihoods: fishers, traders, wardens, mercenaries, skalds—not only raiders.
- Let women/elders hold seats and steer deals; avoid monolith tropes.
- Lean into seasonality and thing assemblies as civic life.

Etiquette Hooks (once/scene in Linn venues): gift the host's hearth with salt/fish oil; name your mother's line; offer a verse—each can grant Position +1 in parley.

8 Factions & Fronts

- **Linns Union (docks & dues):** Strings—dock priority, barge pilots.
- **Mistland Wardens:** Strings—fog bell chains, cliff beacons.
- **Yloka Tollmen:** Strings—boom-chains, river seals.
- **Dolmis Factors:** Strings—winter contracts, bonded warehouses.
- **Shrine of Storm-Whale:** Strings—safe-run chants, tithe.

Front Timers (examples):

- Reprisals Fleet [6–8] (coastal power organizes counterstrike).
- Thing Schism [6] (oath controversies split halls).
- Mistland Famine [6] (trade mission needed; gain Standing if solved).

9 Generators

9.1 Coastal Targets (d66)

11 tide mill • 12 beacon tower • 13 cliff monastery • 14 saltworks • 15 fishing fleet • 16 lord's boathouse • 21 skerry storehouse • 22 ropewalk • 23 ferry-chain • 24 dyeshed • 25 customs shed • 26 river gate • 31 amber beach • 32 quarry pier • 33 seal rookery • 36 barge yard • 35 sheep isle • 36 fortress quay • 41 smokehouse row • 42 eel-weirs • 43 pilot stone • 44 winter harbor • 45 tax sloop • 46 river lighthouse • 51 shrine cove • 52 smugglers' cut • 53 patrol launch • 54 tollhouse • 55 grain pier • 56 seawall breach • 61 ice slip • 62 wreckers' fires • 63 tide cave • 64 chain boom • 65 slate wharf • 66 mint barge.

9.2 River Hazards (d12)

1 bar on a bend • 2 sudden freshet • 3 weir rat-lines • 4 deadwood snag • 5 eel-pots • 6 ice pans • 7 hidden side-cut • 8 bluff echo • 9 toll chain half-raised • 10 reeds conceal archers • 11 rain-swollen ford • 12 sand-suck bank.

9.3 Thing Cases (d12)

1 insult in song • 2 stolen pilot stone • 3 broken oath on winter grain • 4 blood-price disputed • 5 marriage claim • 6 warding chant stolen • 7 hostage pledge lapsed • 8 salvage rights • 9 border cairn moved • 10 feud cooling terms • 11 saga witness contest • 12 mercenary pay withheld.

9.4 Sagas & Boons (d12)

1 oar-song that steadies arms • 2 whale omen at dawn • 3 amber find • 4 pilot's ghost shows a cut • 5 storm-whale spares you • 6 omen of red sails • 7 skald's verse spreads • 8 winter hall adopts you • 9 river seal renewed • 10 cliff bell silent • 11 mist opens path • 12 oath-ring warms (truth told).

10 Integration Notes

- **Amaranthine Sea:** Use ship chase and blockade tools; Linn Skald-Drum converts Audience to Favor once/score in port riots or dock disputes.
- **Caravans:** Swap staging at waystations with winter harbors; River-Runner aids barge convoys upriver.
- **Wilderness:** Portage/overland jumps tie into outpost assets; fjord hunts use Hunt/Chase ladders.
- **Political Intrigue:** Treat the Thing as a political venue; Repute sets default Position; Blood-Silver interacts with Favor/Exposure economies.

- **Psionics:** Seers translate as omen-readers; allow Psychic Weather Sense to soften fog/ice penalties once/leg.
- **Dragon's Lair:** Skerries and glacier valleys hide wrym shrines; oaths may bind to ancient powers for perilous boons.

11 Example of Play (short)

Setup: Longhull with Shallow Draft, Mistwise, Wolf-Boarding Gear. Crew Repute 3/6, Feud 1/4 (with Yloka Tollmen). Score: River Strike against a boom-chain tollhouse (Plunder/Terms).

Approach: Parley-then-Shock. Speaker petitions for winter discount (DV 3). Partial → Position stays Controlled, GM spends 1 SB.

Action: War-Leader triggers Board & Brace at the boom. Wolf-Boarding Gear drops DV to 3. Hit → Plunder +2; a 1 shows → GM spends Tower Fire (Alarm +1, Pursuit +1).

Twist: Fog rolls in. Mistwise cancels Position penalty. Steersman runs a Pilots' Stone line: Navigate gains Position +1; Pursuit -1.

Close: Plunder fills. Crew chooses a seasonal tithe String instead of coin. Blood-Price at 2/4; they pledge blood-silver at winter thing to avoid Feud tick.

12 GM Reference (one page)

- **Crew:** Repute [6] • Feud [4] • Exposure [6] • Oath Ledger.
- **Ships:** choose hull + 3–4 tags. Roles: Steersman • War-Leader • Speaker • Skald • Shorehand • Lookout.
- **Season Wheel:** Spring muster • Summer raids • Autumn trade/settle • Winter thing.
- **Score Types:** Coastal Raid • River Strike • Escort/Trade • Thing Moot.
- **Key Timers:** Alarm • Plunder • Ship Damage • Blood-Price • Pursuit.
- **Weather/Ice:** Fog/Mist • Squall/Hail • Ice/Floe.
- **SB Menu:** Hidden Shoal • Tower Fire • Oarline Breaks • Witness at Cliff • Saga Twisted.
- **Integration:** Portage ↔ Wilderness • Dock riots ↔ Amaranthine • Thing ↔ Political • Omens ↔ Psionics.

13 Changelog

v0.1 — First draft: crew/ship sheets, tags & roles, season wheel, sea/river procedures, raid/river/thing scores, oath & blood-silver economy, generators, integration, and an example.

End of v0.1

Hunger in the Mist

A Linn Adventure for Fate's Edge (v0.1)

Hunger in the Mist

A Linn Adventure for Fate's Edge (v0.1)

A coastal-river saga for Tier II–III parties, inspired by northern raiding epics and survival horror—reimagined for Fate's Edge without referencing any specific IP. Built to slot into Linn: Mist & Iron, Wilderness, Caravans, Amaranthine Sea, Political Intrigue, and Psionics.

Pitch

Winter's edge bites the Mistlands. Beacon towers fail. Villages whisper of Fog-Harriers—antler-helmed raiders who strike from fen and chalk caves, leaving carrion totems and vanished kin. The Linn hall of Stenskar seals its doors... then sends for help. The omens demand a mixed company: oarsmen and outsiders together, for the mist does not remember one tongue alone.

Play in 3–5 sessions: defend a hall; scout the black fen; unmask the Harriers; strike the warrens; end a brood-line at dawn.

Safety & Tone

- Horror and funerary imagery; keep consent tools handy.
- Keep Linn culture plural: traders, fishers, skalds, wardens—not caricature raiders.
- The Fog-Harriers are a syncretic cult of coastal and fen folk (not a “lost people” stereotype). Their practices are ritual, not racial.

What You Need

- Fate's Edge core SRD (Position/DV, SB, timers, Strings).
- Linn: Mist & Iron (crew/ship tags, thing, oaths, sea/river ladders).
- Wilderness (camp, biomes: marsh/coast). Optional: Psionics (omens), Political (thing moot), Caravans/Sea if you bring escort/convoy play.

14 Cast & Hooks

PC hooks (choose or invent):

- Outsider Envoy from a southern city bearing a winter contract.
- Skald-Loud: your saga named a fen spirit; it answered.

- Mistland Warden: your bell-chain went silent; your oath binds you to find why.
- River Pilot: your pilot stones were moved; trade boats vanish.
- Noetic Adept (Psionics): your dreams taste of chalk and marrow; omens point north.

Notables

- Jarl Arnhild Stenskar (Speaker at winter thing). Strings: winter harbor, feud settlement.
- Hevr Skarn (War-Leader). String: oar-oath.
- Friga of the Bell Chain (Warden). String: beacon rites.
- The Fog-Harriers (cult). Strings: bog totems, whisper warrens, marrow resin.
- The Brood-Matron (Harrier oracle). String: bone throne in the chalk deeps.

15 Fronts & Timers

Primary front — Hunger in the Mist

- Beacon Silence [6] — as it fills, coastal beacons fail; +1 Position to Harrier night strikes.
- Missing Boats [6] — trade collapses; famine pressure rises.
- Brood-Matron's Rite [8] — completes a mass anointing; Harriers fight at +1 Effect at night.

Local timers

- Hall Panic [6] — rumor and grief; insert disadvantage tags until calmed.
- Feud with Tollmen [4] — complicates river help; clear at thing or pay blood-silver.
- Oath Debts [4] — favors owed by Stenskar; cash for aid or betrayal.

16 Adventure Structure

16.1 Act I — The Hall at Dusk (Defense & Oaths)

Scene A1: River Arrival

- Enter by longhull or barge under fog. Mistwise helps; otherwise Position −1 to Navigate.
- Encounter: wreckers' fires lure boats to a shoal (Hidden Shoal SB). Rescue or lose supplies.

Scene A2: Stenskar Winter Hall

- A funeral table, skalds quiet, children hidden. Hall Panic [6] starts at 2/6.
- Thinglet: a small moot in the hall: testimonies about antler masks and bog-incense.

- Oath: Arnhild swears guest-right and asks for a mixed company. Add Oar-Oath String: one boon per session on a roll taken in public defense of Stenskar.

Scene A3: Night Probe

- Harriers test the palisade with bone rattles and peat-smoke. Use Board & Brace if defending the river gate; ranged volleys are hampered by fog.
- On any 1, spend SB Witness at Cliff (enemy skiff sees you); tick Missing Boats +1.

Outcomes: stabilize Hall Panic, earn Beacon Rite String (Warden's trust), discover marrow resin (sweet narcotic used by Harriers).

16.2 Act II — Black Fen Recon (Scouting & Skirmish)

Travel: Wilderness Marsh biome; set Distance [6], Danger [4], Weather [4: fog/rain].

Intent: Scout or Hide to reduce Sign.

Key Sites

- Bell Chain #7: rope cut, bell stolen; recover clapper for Clue.
- Totem Isle: antler totems, peat-fires burning cold; a captive left as bait.
- Pilot Stone Cairn: moved downstream; reset to ease escape later (Position +1 on retreat).
- Fen Bear's Den: optional hunt; pelt as leverage at thing.

Encounters

- Harrier Skirmishers (Near): reed-masks, bone darts (Harm 1, poison tag Drowse → Weariness +1).
- Bog-Haze: Weather tick; on 1, Condition +1 unless Shelter tag.
- Whisper Caves Mouth: chalk dust, singing vents; enter now or return prepared.

Objectives

- Track the Harriers to the warrens (accumulate 3 Clues: totem analysis, captive interrogation, resin tracing).
- Seize totems/resin to learn their rite.
- Optionally bargain at riverside Thing to clear Feud with Tollmen.

16.3 Act III — The Whisper Warrens (Assault & Choice)

Dungeon Frame: single timer Warrens Depth [8]; three spokes: Bone Gallery, Steam Vents, Brood Halls. Advance on noise, heat, or delay. Harriers get Position +1 in darkness unless PCs carry warding light.

Rooms & Beats

1. Bone Gallery: trophy totems; a riddle-song carved in chalk (Insight DV 3 decodes entry order; on 1, Alarm [4] +1).
2. Steam Vents: scalding fog bursts; Cross Hazard DV 3–4.
3. Brood Halls: sleeping pits; marrow resin harvest; captives. Mercy vs Zeal choice: rescue captives (slows assault, gain 1 Boon) or leave them (assault faster, Harriers fight with +1 Effect until Brood-Matron's Rite is reduced).

The Brood-Matron

- Oracle-chieftain enthroned on jointed bone. Uses Drowse fumes, reed-pipes to coordinate, and antler staff to parry.
- Moves: Frenzy the Pack (allies gain +1 Effect for one exchange), Fog Veil (Position –1 for intruders), Marrow Breath (Weariness +1 area; SB spend).
- Strings: prophecy tokens (chalk sticks carved with tide glyphs) and a Bone Oath Ring that can settle Feud at a Thing if claimed.

Finale Options

- Strike the Matron: break the cult's coordination; Harriers fragment.
- Collapse the Vents: explosives or psionic overpressure to seal the warrens (Weather +1; retreat timer).
- Parley of Oaths: prove the Matron bent an ancient river oath; some Harriers stand down under witness.

Aftermath: if Brood-Matron's Rite was near full, pockets of Harriers fight on at night until Beacon Silence is restored.

17 Running the Fog-Harriers

They are human cultists. Their horror comes from ritual masks, peat-smoke tactics, and night discipline, not species. Frame them as a fen syncretic sect that fed on famine and fear. Some defect when confronted with oaths and proofs.

Harrier Types (framework)

- Skirmisher: reed mask, bone darts (Near), marsh knife (Close). Tags: Drowse, Reedslip (Hide/Disengage Position +1 in marsh). DV: 3 for ranged, 2 for melee.
- Reaver: antler helm, hooked spear (Close), net (entangle). Tag: Hook & Haul (on hit, reposition foe). DV: 2 for melee.
- Whisperer: smoke-runner, pipe-signals, resin flasks. Move: Fog Veil (once/scene Position -1 to ranged against allies). DV: 2.
- Brood-Matron: see above. DV: 4, Harm 2.

Use core opposition building: set DV by venue/cover (marsh, fog, night), hand out SB on 1s, and lean on Reedslip/Hook & Haul to shape the fight.

18 Oaths, Law, & Thing

- A Hall Thinglet can grant Witness for an oath; use it to settle Feud with Tollmen or bind local aid.
- Blood-Silver converts one Feud tick into truce; Boast publicly and fulfill it to gain Repute +1 at winter thing.
- The Bone Oath Ring from the warrens is admissible proof at a Thing; returning it can grant Standing with Mistland Wardens.

19 Wilderness & Travel Procedures

- Marsh Biome: Infiltrate Position +1; Drive Position -1. Hazards: sucking mud (Cross DV 3-5), miasma (Weariness +1 + Sickness [4]), hidden channel (Swim/Boat).
- Weather Matrix (Fog/Rain/Ice): see Wilderness; fog adds Pursuit +1 on 1s unless Mistwise.

Sample Leg: Stenskar → Black Fen Mouth (Distance [4], Danger [4], Weather [4: fog]). Intent Hide. On strong Hide Sign, reduce Sign -2; on 1, Witness at Cliff SB.

20 Sea & River Hooks

- River Strike: sabotage boom-chains raising for Harrier skiffs (Pursuit/Current timers).
- Escort: run refugees or grain; Skald-Drum can convert Audience: Warm → Favor at a desperate dock.
- Ambush at Sea: Harrier cutters use kelp curtains; Mistwise counters.

21 Psionics Hooks (optional)

- Dream Weather: Noetic PC senses chalk singing → Clue to vent map; reduce Warrens Depth advance once.
- Aegis of Will: disperse dart volleys (convert Harm 1 → Fatigue).
- Foresight: warn of a night probe; set Hall Defense Position +1.

22 Rewards & Fallout

Strings: Beacon Rites • Bone Oath Ring • Winter Harbor • Pilot's Stones Reset • Tollmen Truce.

Boons: Mist opens path (Position +1 on a fog scene once) • Skald's Verse spreads (Audience: Warm on arrival).

Standing: with Mistland Wardens, Dock unions, or Linn thing.

Treasure: marrow resin (contraband), antler crafts, river seals, captives ransomed.

Campaign Ripples:

- The marrow resin points to a southern buyer → city or sea arc.
- The Bone Oath Ring ties to an ancient river oath → political arc.
- The chalk vents hint at wyrm channels → dragon arc.

23 Prep Aids

Visible timers to start: Beacon Silence 2/6 • Missing Boats 1/6 • Hall Panic 2/6.

Handouts: Oath tokens, totem sketches, bell-chain map, pilot stones diagram.

Music: low frame drum; distant bells; water drip.

24 One-Page Reference

- Acts: Hall Defense → Fen Recon → Warrens Assault/Parley.
- Key Tags: Mistwise • Shallow Draft • River-Runner • Reedslip • Drowse.
- SB Menu (Mist & Iron): Hidden Shoal • Tower Fire • Oarline Breaks • Witness at Cliff • Saga Twisted.
- Wilderness SB: Unwelcome Smoke • Bad Footing • Foul Water.
- Timers: Beacon Silence • Missing Boats • Brood-Matron's Rite • Hall Panic • Feud (Tollmen) • Oath Debts.
- Outcomes: Matron struck • Vents collapsed • Oaths proven.
- Advancement: Repute shift • Standing gained • Strings banked.

25 Changelog

v0.1 — First pass: three-act structure, fronts/timers, scenes/venues, enemies, oaths & thing, wilderness/river/psionic hooks, rewards, and a one-page reference.

End of v0.1

26 The Faith of the Linn: Shrine, Temple, and the Weight of the Word

The old gods ask for oaths. The new god asks for silence. I am not sure which is harder to give. Skald Aud of the Broken Keel, at the Thing of Stenskar, 847 AR

26.1 The Old Shrines: Oath, Tide, and Hearth

Before the Temple of Light sent its first missionaries across the Dolmis, before the Thepyrgosi Synod codified its doctrines, the Linn kept faith with powers who asked for no prayers—only *witness*. The old shrines are not buildings. They are **places of memory**: a sea-stack where a chieftain swore to return, a hearthstone where a foster-child was named, a cairn where a drowned crew was given to Vélki's tide.

26.1.1 The Patrons of the Shrines

The Linn do not have a pantheon. They have **oath-kin**—powers who are addressed only when a debt is owed or a word must be sealed.

Hrævkn (the Frost-Raven) Witness of the Thing, whose ravens perch on the gables of every moot-hall. He does not speak; he *counts*. Every oath sworn on the oath-ring adds a feather to his tally. Every broken vow feathers his nest for winter.

Vélki (the Wave-Sworn) She who was the first to bleed into the tide and drown. She sits on a throne of whalebone in the Abderrin Trench. When a Linn dies at sea, her hand rises through the waves to pull the body down—not in malice, but in *collection*. The sea gives passage; the sea takes its price.

Skáldyr (the Boast-Eater) A shape that lives in the pause before the punchline, the tension of a harp string held too long. He feeds on *public promises*. A boast made before witnesses is a prayer. A boast broken leaves the boaster with a mouth full of ash.

Iarnvöllr (the Iron-Field) Not a being but a *place*: a phantom battlefield that appears at dawn where the unburied dead of old raids walk in silent formation. They seek oaths, not blood. A living Linn who swears to retrieve a fallen comrade's weapon may pass through the Iron-Field unharmed. One who breaks that oath joins the march.

Hvítabjörn (the White Bear) A great winter-walker who tests hospitality. He appears during the first blizzard, shaking snow from his fur at the door of a longhouse. If the household offers

the first cup of mead, he stays until spring, keeping wolves from the fold. If they refuse, he leaves, and no guest will arrive until the thaw.

These are not gods to be worshipped. They are **creditors**. A Linn does not pray to Vélki for safe passage; she makes a *vow* to return a third of her plunder to the deep. A Linn does not ask Hraevkn for wisdom; he swears a *boast* before the Thing and trusts that the raven is counting.

At the table: Shrine-devout Linn (Devotion −2 or −3) gain **+1d** on rites or diplomacy conducted at a recognized shrine (a sea-stack, a moot-ring, a hearthstone). However, they begin social scenes in Temple-controlled venues at **Position −1**, as southern clerics eye them with suspicion.

26.2 The Temple of Light: The Southern Doctrine

The Temple of Light arrived not with armies but with **scribes, bells, and ledgers**. Thepyrgosi missionaries first came to the Linn coast during the reign of the Sea-Queen Hella Ironside, offering grain in exchange for permission to build a single chapel at Fairport. Within a generation, the Temple had established scriptoria, synod courts, and a network of **bell-towers** that marked time in the southern fashion—eight bells for Lauds, nine for the Angelus, a counting that still troubles Linn elders.

26.2.1 What the Temple Teaches

The Temple of Light preaches a unified cosmology: one source of illumination, one hierarchy of saints and confessors, one law written in scripture rather than sworn on iron. Its priests carry **candles of witness**, not oath-rings. Confession is private, not public. Salvation is a matter of *grace*, not *interest*.

To a Linn ear, this sounds like a debt that can never be paid—because no price is named.

Yet the Temple has spread for three reasons:

1. **Grain.** Linn winters are long. Temple granaries, stocked with southern grain, have saved villages from famine—and those villages now ring the Angelus.
2. **Law.** The Temple's canon law offers a way to *end* feuds, not merely suspend them. A blood-price can be paid to the Temple's poor fund, not to a rival clan. For Linn exhausted by generations of killing, this is seductive.
3. **Writing.** The old faith is oral. Oaths are remembered, not recorded. The Temple offers *indulgences*—parchment receipts for confessed sins, admissible in any synod court. To a culture that tracks strings and favors with knotted cords, a written receipt feels like *technology*.

At the table: Temple-devout Linn (Devotion +2 or +3) gain **+1d** on rites conducted in a consecrated church or on social rolls within a Temple-friendly venue. However, they begin scenes in shrine-controlled strongholds (cliff shrines, moot-rings, ancestral cairns) at **Position -1**, and any boast made before witnesses suffers **-1d** unless they ritually "convert" it into a written petition.

26.3 The Devotion Spectrum: Five Faces of Linn Faith

Most Linn do not sit at either extreme. They shift with the season, the harvest, and the proximity of a Temple granary. The **Devotion Spectrum** tracks this tension mechanically (see §25.1), but the *fiction* of each band is what brings the world to life.

26.3.1 -3: Shrine-Devout (Pure Shrine)

"The raven knows my name. Does your god know yours?"

These Linn keep to the old ways. They swear oaths on iron rings, not parchment. They leave offerings of blood-silver at sea-stacks for Vélki. They refuse Temple grain even in famine. In shrines, they speak with the authority of generations. In Temple courts, they are sullen, evasive, and dangerous.

Typical communities: remote fjord villages, skerry-dwelling fishers, clans with a long feud history (they trust no outside law).

26.3.2 -2: Shrine-Leaning

"The old ways are hard. But they are our ways."

These Linn honor the shrine patrons but will trade with Temple merchants. They attend Thing, not synod. They may send a child to a Temple school for writing lessons—but the child must still swear a first oath on the family's oath-ring. They are the **backbone of resistance** to full conversion.

Typical communities: mixed coastal towns with a Thing-hall but also a Temple chapel; clans that have intermarried with southern families but kept their own hearth-traditions.

26.3.3 -1 to +1: Mixed / Unsure (The Bridge-Walkers)

"I pour for the raven and kneel for the candle. Both have fed my children."

Most Linn live here. They will swear an oath at the Thing and also confess to a Temple priest—different debts, different creditors. They name their children with old shrine-names (Wave-Sworn, Raven-Counted) but also give them Temple baptismal names. They are **pragmatic, not devout**. The spectrum moves for them only when a crisis forces a choice: a failed harvest blamed on neglected shrines, or a plague that Temple healers cannot cure.

Bridge-Walkers (Devotion 0) have no innate mechanical edge but may qualify for **Ambassador Status** (see §25.1) and are the most likely to earn **Synthesis Tokens** for blending practices.

26.3.4 +2: Temple-Leaning

"The ledger is clearer than the memory. I know what I owe."

These Linn have largely converted to the Temple of Light. They attend synod courts, not Things.

They keep written accounts of debts and favors—strings replaced by parchment. They may still visit a shrine on feast days, but they do so *quietly*, lest their Temple neighbors see. They are often wealthier than their shrine-devout kin, because Temple trade networks reach farther.

Typical communities: port towns with regular southern shipping, mercenary companies that fought for Thepyrgos or Ecktoria, families that lost a feud and used Temple arbitration to end it.

26.3.5 +3: Pure Temple

"The old gods take. The Light gives."

These Linn have fully abandoned the shrines. They see the old patrons as demons or delusions.

They are zealous, often converts of the second generation. They serve as Temple missionaries, judges, and scribes. In shrine-controlled villages, they may be met with cold silence or violence. They are the shock troops of the **Northern Crusade**—and they are hated by many of their own kin.

Typical communities: Temple school graduates, families that were dispossessed by feud and found refuge in Temple lands, urban Linn in southern cities like Fairport or Thepyrgos itself.

26.4 The Northern Crusade: How the Temple of Light Presses North

The Temple of Light does not send armies. It sends **famine, law, and literacy**—and when those fail, it sends **justiciars with bells**.

26.4.1 Stage One: The Grain Mission

Temple missionaries arrive in a lean winter with shiploads of southern grain. They offer it freely, no strings—except a small chapel built by spring, a bell tower that marks the hours, a scribe who will write letters for those who cannot write. The first converts are the hungry and the curious.

26.4.2 Stage Two: The Synod Court

Once a Temple chapel is established, the bishop appoints a **synod judge**. This judge hears disputes that would normally go to the Thing. The judge uses canon law, which is written, consistent, and *slow*. For clans exhausted by blood-feud, this slow justice feels like mercy. For the shrine-devout, it feels like theft of their lawful authority.

The synod judge also hears *confessions*. A Linn who confesses a broken oath to the Temple is not required to pay blood-silver—only to perform penance: a pilgrimage, a donation, a prayer. This undermines the entire shrine economy, which runs on compensation, not absolution.

26.4.3 Stage Three: The School

Where there is a synod court, there is a school. Children learn to read the Temple's script, to count in the southern fashion (eight bells to Lauds, nine to the Angelus), to write their names in ledgers. The schoolmaster is also a missionary. He does not destroy the old stories; he *rewrites* them. Hrævkn becomes a demon. Vélki becomes a cautionary tale about the perils of sea-worship. The White Bear becomes a metaphor for Christ's hospitality.

26.4.4 Stage Four: The Bell and the Banner

When a village has a chapel, a synod court, and a school, the Temple raises a **bell-tower** with a bronze bell cast in Thepyrgos. It rings eight times each morning. The old shrine bells—iron, cracked, tuned to the older counting—fall silent. The Temple also sends a **banner**: a white field with a golden candle, to be flown on feast days. In some villages, the shrine banner (a raven, a white bear, a wave) is relegated to a back wall. In others, it is burned.

The Northern Crusade is not a single war but a *process*. GMs can track it with a **Temple Pressure [6]** timer in a region. Each tick represents a new chapel, a synod court, a school, a bell-tower. When the timer fills, the region becomes Temple-controlled (venue tags shift to Temple District or Contested Ground). Player actions can tick the timer backward by restoring a shrine, exposing a corrupt synod judge, or leading a successful raid against a Temple granary.

26.5 The Faith Tensions in Play: Example Scenes

26.5.1 Scene: The Thing at Winter Hearth

The Thing convenes to settle a feud. The shrine-devout demand blood-silver paid in iron and cattle. The Temple-leaning faction proposes synod arbitration: the feud is confessed, penance assigned, the matter closed. The jarl, a Bridge-Walker (Devotion 0), must choose. The GM sets a **Faith Tension** of Medium (rumors, side-eyes, low-level feuds). Faith-marked actions suffer 1 Position.

Player options:

- Side with the shrine-devout and gain a **String** (*Feud Token*) with that clan.
- Side with the Temple and gain a **String** (*Synod Indulgence*) with the bishop.
- Attempt a **syncretic resolution**: blood-silver paid to the Temple's poor fund, followed by a shrine blessing. This requires a **Synthesis Token** (see §25.1) or a hard roll.

26.5.2 Scene: The Bishop's Progress

A Temple bishop tours the coastal villages, consecrating new chapels. At each stop, he offers grain and scripture. Shrine-devout elders see their influence wane. The GM assigns a **Contested**

Ground venue tag: both sides suffer 1 Position on faith actions unless they can frame their approach as bridge-building.

Player hook: A shrine-devout skald asks the party to steal the bishop's *bell-clapper*—a relic said to contain a fragment of the True Candle. Without it, the consecration cannot proceed. The party must infiltrate the bishop's camp, avoid his Thepyrgosi guards, and escape across the frozen fjord.

26.5.3 Scene: The Convert's Shame

A Temple-leaning Linn has agreed to testify against her own clan in a synod court, accusing them of "idolatry" (shrine worship). Her shrine-devout kin have declared a feud. She is now trapped in the Temple compound, afraid to leave.

Player options:

- Smuggle her to a neutral port (escort mission, uses River-Runner or Mistwise tags).
- Convince the synod judge to drop the case (social scene, requires **Belief Flexibility** or **Ambassador Status**).
- Help her perform a **dual-oath** (shrine and Temple together) that satisfies both sides, earning a **Synthesis Token** and potentially creating a new syncretic tradition—but marking her as a heretic to both extremists.

26.6 Cross-Cultural Resonance: The Deep Threads

The Linn faith does not exist in isolation. Its shapes echo in other cultures across Fate's Edge—not because of borrowing, but because certain *structures of obligation* recur wherever people face the sea, the winter, and the problem of keeping promises.

26.6.1 The Thepyrgosi Thread (Syllogistic Theology)

The Temple of Light's canon law shares a deep structure with the **Thepyrgosi syllogism**: if A owes B, and B owes C, then A owes C. This is simple debt transfer. The Linn old faith holds a different logic: if A swears an oath to B, and B witnesses A's boast, then *B becomes part of the debt*—a tripartite structure (debtor, creditor, witness) that Thepyrgosi scholastics find inefficient.

In play: Thepyrgosi clerics attempting to convert Linn often stumble over the witness requirement. "Why does the raven need to know?" they ask. "Because the raven *is* the memory," the Linn reply.

26.6.2 The Dhaharan Thread (Mandala of Exchange)

The Dhaharan principalities, far to the south, have no shrines to ravens or white bears. But their **mandala of exchange**—the idea that all transactions, spiritual and material, are mirrored across a cosmic ledger—maps cleanly onto the Linn understanding of Vélki's tide-debt. A Dhaharan merchant would recognize Vélki immediately: she is a *karmic creditor*, no different from a temple accountant.

In play: A Dhaharan trader who understands the Linn faith can negotiate blood-silver using Dhaharan ledger principles. This creates a **Bridge-Walker** moment (Devotion 0) where two very different cultures find a shared language of debt.

26.6.3 The Aeler Thread (Keystone and Oath)

The Aeler, those mountain engineers, keep their own faith in **keystone clauses**—promises carved in stone, witnessed by bells, enforced by gravity. An Aeler tunnel-wright would find the Linn oath-ring perfectly legible: it is a *load-bearing promise*, a contract signed in breath rather than chisel.

In play: An Aeler Runekeeper serving a Linn crew may interpret their boasts as Rites, marking Obligation to Hraevkn rather than to a Patron. This is not conversion; it is *translation*. The GM may allow such a character to use **Synthesis Tokens** to blend Linn shrine rites with Aeler ledgers.

26.7 Faith, Saga, and the Shape of a Life

The Saga System (§26) is the perfect engine for tracking a Linn's faith journey. A character's Devotion should move rarely—only at major story beats:

- **Shrine-Devout (−3) to Mixed (−1):** After surviving a winter on Temple grain, a Linn may lose faith in the old ways. Mechanically, this is a **Story-Shaping Decision** worth 1–2 Saga Points.
- **Mixed (0) to Temple-Leaning (+2):** After a synod court ends a blood-feud that had lasted three generations, a clan may convert en masse. This is a **Legendary Deed** (Oath-Keeper Supreme) and may grant a permanent **Syncretic Tradition** boon.
- **Temple-Leaning (+2) to Pure Temple (+3):** A character becomes a missionary, a justiciar, a bell-caster. They gain the **Belief Flexibility** talent (4 XP) for free—but they also gain a **Heretic** tag in shrine-devout venues.

26.7.1 Saga Scenes of Faith

When a player declares a **Saga Scene** (§26.5) in a faith context, the spotlight should illuminate the *cost* of belief:

- A shrine-devout skald sings the old names in a Temple chapel (Position +1 for the first roll, but the GM may spend 1 SB to have a synod judge arrive mid-verse).
- A Temple-leaning justiciar pronounces a shrine a demon-house and orders it burned. She gains +1d on her Command roll, but her shadow now has a raven's silhouette (a Saga Scar, usable by the GM for future complications).
- A Bridge-Walker mediates between a shrine-devout clan and a Temple bishop. She earns a **Synthesis Token** immediately, but both sides demand a *reciprocal oath*—and she is now the witness.

26.8 The Ninth Bell and the Unfinished Count

The Temple of Light rings nine bells to mark the Angelus. The old shrines ring eight—and stop.

This is not an accident. The **Ninth Bell** is the one that opens the door to the Hollow, to the Iron-Field, to the space where debts are not paid but *forgotten*.

In Linn belief, the Temple's ninth bell is not a prayer. It is a *threat*. It says: *you owe more than you can count*. The old faith answers: *then count to eight, and stop. The ninth is not for you*.

GM seed: A Temple bell-tower in a recently converted village begins ringing a ninth bell at midnight. Livestock sicken. Children walk in their sleep toward the sea. The shrine-devout say the old patrons are angry. The Temple says the devil is testing the faithful. The truth is simpler: the bell was cast from iron salvaged from a ship that sank without burial. The drowned are counting.

The old gods count your breaths. The new god counts your sins. Neither will let you forget. The question is which ledger you would rather read at midnight. Dusana of the Raven Road, at the Thing of Stenskar, after the ninth bell fell silent

26.9 Temple of Light, Shrines, and the Devotion Spectrum

The Temple of Light and the old shrine cults do not exist as a simple on/off switch. Most Linn live somewhere along a sliding scale of tradition and new faith. Rather than tracking separate factions in detail, use the following light-weight overlays on existing mechanics (Position, SB, Tags, and Conditions).

The Devotion Spectrum

Each character (or crew, if you prefer) may mark a single **Devotion value** from −3 to +3:

−3 → −2 → −1 → **0** → +1 → +2 → +3

- −3: **Pure Shrine** — openly devoted to patrons, deeply suspicious of Temple.
- −1 to +1: **Mixed / Unsure** — lives in both worlds, or keeps faith private.
- +3: **Pure Temple** — openly devout; treats shrines as questionable or obsolete.

When It Moves

- Only move Devotion on **major story beats**: public conversions, dramatic repudiations of a faith, founding or closing a shrine/Temple, or major miracles.
- A quiet personal doubt is color; a public oath-breaking before a hall can shift the track.

Mechanical Edge (Extremes Only) Devotion only has direct mechanical teeth at:

- -2 or -3 : **Shrine-Favored** — gain **+1d** on patron rites or shrine diplomacy; suffer -1 Position in clearly Temple-dominated venues.
- **0**: **Bridge-Walker** — no innate bonus, but can qualify for *Ambassador Status* (below).
- $+2$ or $+3$: **Temple-Favored** — gain **+1d** on Temple rites or Temple court scenes; suffer -1 Position in shrine strongholds.

Venue Tags & Faith-Based Position

Instead of detailed faction sheets, give each important location a single **faith tag**:

- **Shrine Stronghold** — hills, halls, or villages bound tightly to patrons.
- **Temple District** — towns with active Temple of Light presence and law.
- **Mixed Quarter** — places where both altars stand; everyday compromise.
- **Contested Ground** — frontiers, halls, or thing-sites where both sides push.

Apply simple Position modifiers:

- **Shrine-Friendly Venue**: Temple-leaning characters ($+2/+3$) suffer -1 Position on overtly faith-based actions unless they show respect or humility.
- **Temple-Friendly Venue**: Shrine-leaning characters ($-2/-3$) suffer -1 Position on faith actions unless they submit to Temple forms.
- **Mixed Quarter**: No automatic penalty; GM may assess -1 Position for open grandstanding by either extreme.
- **Contested Ground**: Both sides suffer -1 Position on faith actions *unless* they can frame their approach as **bridge-building**. The GM may spend **1 SB** to create a brief opening where a sincere mediator can act at neutral Position.

Faith Tension as a Scene Tag

Treat religious tension like weather or terrain: a **scene-level tag** that sits on top of everything else.

Low Tension Everyday life. No special modifiers.

Medium Tension Rumors, side-eyes, low-level feuds. *Faith-marked* actions (invoking shrines, Temple doctrine, public prayers) suffer -1 Position.

High Tension Open feuding, recent blasphemy, or fresh Temple decrees. Opposing-faith interactions take DV + 1 and generate automatic **Exposure +1** on failure.

The GM can adjust Faith Tension up or down when:

- A public slight, miracle, or atrocity occurs.
- A Saga Scene (§27) plays out around faith.

Synthesis Tokens: Blending Practices

When characters successfully blend shrine and Temple practices in a scene *and* the table agrees it feels earned (shared prayers, joint rites, dual-oath funerals):

- The crew gains a **Synthesis Token** (treat like a *Boon* that can only be spent in faith contexts).

A Synthesis Token may be spent to:

- Improve Position by one step for a faith-based action (e.g. Controlled→Controlled).
- Gain **+1d** on diplomacy between Temple and shrine factions.
- Declare **temporary safe passage** through otherwise hostile religious territory for a single scene (guards stand aside, elders agree to host, etc.).

Unused Tokens do not stack endlessly; the crew may hold at most **two** Synthesis Tokens at a time.

Dual Oaths & Spiritual Conflict

Some characters swear both to a patron shrine and the Temple of Light.

You do not need a separate timer; instead, when you roll for a clearly faith-marked action while holding **both** shrine-oath and Temple vow:

- If the roll shows one or more **1s**, you must **choose** which faith is offended by how you acted.
- The offended side gains a narrative opening: colder reactions, whispers, or calls to prove yourself later.

If you refuse to choose:

- Mark the **Spiritual Conflict** Condition: “*Pulled Between Altars*” (−1 die to faith actions until resolved).
- Resolve it by taking a clear, public stand in a dramatic scene: favor one faith, attempt a risky synthesis, or refuse both and accept the fallout.

Ritual Adaptation & Contamination

When you perform shrine rites in explicitly Temple spaces (or Temple rites in fiercely shrine-held space), you are stepping into dangerous territory.

GM SB Use (Ritual Adaptation) When characters attempt mixed rites:

- **1 SB:** Minor offense (wrong tool, clumsy phrasing) — social awkwardness, hushed whispers.
- **2 SB:** Moderate tension — rumors, open criticism, minor feud Timers tick.
- **3+ SB:** Major conflict — accusations of blasphemy, forced choices, or legal challenges.

Contamination Tokens Additionally, if the rite is clearly “in the wrong place,” the GM may mark a **Contamination Token** on the character or venue:

- While holding a Contamination Token, you suffer −1 die to *all* faith-based rolls linked to that space or rite.
- Clear a Token by:
 - Spending part of downtime on cleansing rites, reparations, or pilgrimages; or
 - Converting it into growth: treat 1 Token as **1 XP** toward a faith-aligned talent or Devotion shift (you learned from your mistake, in public).

Faith Ambassadors & Flexible Belief

Some characters become known as bridge-builders, mediators, or “those who can speak to both altars”.

Ambassador Status A character who has *successfully* mediated at least two serious faith conflicts (GM judgment) may be granted **Ambassador Status**:

- Mark a single checkbox or tag: *Temple–Shrine Ambassador*.
- Once per session, convert a *faith-based Position penalty* (e.g. from venue or Devotion) into an equivalent **bonus** for a single roll (e.g. Controlled→Controlled), by explicitly leaning on their reputation as a neutral voice.
- Refresh Ambassador Status when you play out another mediation scene that matters.

Optional Talent: Belief Flexibility For characters who intentionally walk the line, you can allow a minor talent:

Belief Flexibility (4 XP) Once per session, ignore faith-alignment Position penalties (from venue tags or Devotion) for a single scene, representing a knack for “reading the room” and speaking both languages.

Limit: You cannot benefit from both shrine *and* Temple-specific mechanical advantages in the same scene (pick which side of your faith is active).

Using Faith in Play

- **Keep It Light** — These tools hang off mechanics you already use (Position, SB, Tags, Conditions). If you are ever tracking more than Devotion, one venue tag, and maybe a Token or two, simplify.
- **Play For Drama** — Use Devotion shifts and Synthesis Tokens to spotlight big, meaningful choices, not background noise.
- **Tie Into Saga** — Faith choices make excellent fuel for the Saga system (§27): conversions, heresy trials, shrine restorations, and Temple victories are all things skalds love to sing about.

27 Saga System: Epic Reputation and Legendary Deeds

Not every story told in smoke-filled halls is true, but the ones that *stick* shape how the world meets you. The Saga System tracks not only what your crew has done, but how those deeds are remembered, twisted, and invoked by others.

Saga Reputation sits alongside personal **Repute**, **Audience** tags, and **Oaths**. Where those mark who knows you locally, Saga Reputation marks when your story starts to move on its own.

27.1 Crew Saga Reputation Track

Each crew maintains a shared **Saga Reputation** track [6] that grows as they perform legendary deeds. This track represents how their exploits are told in halls across the northern lands.

- **Saga 1–2: Local Tales** — Known by name in nearby settlements; a few skalds are watching your story.
- **Saga 3–4: Regional Fame** — Songs and verses carry your deeds along trade routes and fjords; strangers recognize you by deeds, if not by face.
- **Saga 5–6: Living Legend** — Your name is invoked in boasts, oaths, and threats. Children play at being you. Enemies plan around you.

Who Tracks It? Saga Reputation is *crew-level*, not individual. Different characters may be more or less central to specific stories, but the world tends to remember “the crew” or “the Linn from the Mistship” as a whole.

27.2 Earning Saga Points

You raise Saga Reputation by earning **Saga Points**. Mark 1–2 Saga Points when the crew does something that people will *actually talk about* later.

Core Triggers

- **Epic Victories** — Defeating foes significantly above your Tier or overturning a seemingly unwinnable situation (e.g. defending a hall against impossible odds).
- **Impossible Feats** — Succeeding at DV 5+ Position tests where the table agrees “this is the kind of thing skalds brag about”.
- **Honor-Keeping** — Fulfilling major oaths under extreme circumstances, especially when keeping the oath costs you dearly.
- **Legendary Sacrifices** — Choosing the harder path for the greater good: voluntary maiming, loss of wealth, exile, or similar stakes.
- **Story-Shaping Decisions** — A choice that permanently alters a hall, village, route, or region (toppling a jarl, ending a feud, founding a Temple or shrine).

GM Guidance

- *Ask*: “Would someone in three winters still be telling this story at a thing?” If yes, award Saga Points. 0
- *Scale*: 1 Saga Point for strong deeds; 2 for true legends that also change fronts or timers on the campaign map.

Each time the Saga track fills [6/6], clear it and advance the crew’s **Saga Tier** by 1 (step their Saga Reputation band up to the next level). Optionally record a short *Saga Line* in the crew sheet: a one-sentence summary skalds repeat.

27.3 Saga Benefits: Position & Social Edge

As Saga Reputation increases, the crew gains powerful Position and advantage benefits that reflect how the world receives them.

Saga 1–2: Local Heroes

Local Hero Once per scene, when *defending your home, kin, or named allies*, one PC may improve Position by one step (Desperate→Controlled or Controlled→Controlled) on a single roll.

Saga 3–4: Regional Champions

Regional Champion Once per session, a PC may declare a specific past deed (“*We held the bridge at Stormfjord for three days*”) that is now widely known. With GM approval, they gain **+1d** to a single roll where that story logically applies (rallying defenders, intimidating raiders, convincing a jarl to trust them, etc.).

Saga 5–6: Living Legends

Legendary Warrior Once per session, when the crew acts in a hall or region where their legend is well-known, one PC may treat any *Controlled* Position as *Dominant* for a single action, reflecting that the world *expects* them to triumph.

Optional: Individual Saga Marks Individual PCs can also record **Saga Marks** for personally famous deeds (see 27.6), but these are color until the GM calls on them for Position shifts, Audience tags, or Strings.

27.4 Saga Complications: Fame as a Knife

Saga Reputation is a double-edged axe. Fame brings attention, expectations, and enemies.

- **Rival Challenges** — At higher Saga levels, the GM is encouraged to introduce rival crews, warriors, or Temple champions who seek glory by besting you. For each Saga Tier above 2, once per arc start a **Rival Challenge** [4] timer.
- **Expectation Burden** — Audience tags tilt toward “*expects-impossible-feats*”. Failures in public scenes may tick additional fallout timers as people feel *betrayed*, not merely disappointed.
- **Target Status** — Enemies who come specifically hunting the famous crew gain **+1d** to *Assess*, *Track*, or *Ambush* rolls against them; their scouts already know your tactics and tales.
- **Saga Debt** — The GM may introduce **Saga Debt** complications: a hall that sheltered you now calls in a favor, a child you inspired has gone missing hunting glory, or someone lied using your name.

As a rule of thumb, for each Saga Tier above 1, allow the GM to add one additional twist or String per session based on fame alone.

27.5 Saga Scenes: Fame Arrives Before You Do

When the crew’s Saga Reputation is **3+**, once per session a player may declare a **Saga Scene**.

- Set the scene in a location where your fame plausibly precedes you: a coastal hall, a trade-town, a Temple court that follows skald verse.
- The active PC begins with **Position +1** on their first significant social interaction (e.g. Controlled instead of Controlled).
- All allies in the scene gain **+1d once** when they explicitly invoke the crew's legend (quoting a verse, showing a trophy, calling on a past deed).
- The scene must showcase the crew's legendary nature in some way: public boast, challenge, judgment, or sacrifice. If it resolves quietly, the GM may rule that no new Saga Points are earned from it.

Saga Scenes are a spotlight tool: use them to turn ordinary negotiations or meetings into memorable chapters in the crew's story.

27.6 Legendary Deeds & Personal Boons

Certain deeds are so monumental that they grant permanent, personal benefits in addition to Saga Points. These should be *rare*, negotiated moments, not routine rewards.

Slayer of Beasts Defeat a creature of myth or a unique monster that has haunted a hall, route, or region for generations. Gain **+1d** on all future rolls directly confronting similar creatures or their kin.

Oath-Keeper Supreme Fulfill an “impossible” oath that multiple NPCs declared unachievable (e.g. “end this blood-feud in a single winter”, “bring both shrine and Temple to the same altar”). Once per session, convert one *single failed* roll related to oath, duty, or honor into a success at *limited* Effect (mark 1 SB as cost).

Shield of the Innocent Defend the defenseless against overwhelming odds in a public, widely-witnessed stand. Gain **+1 Armor** (non-stacking) when you explicitly protect others, even without a physical shield.

Master of Elements Survive an impossible natural force (shipwreck, avalanche, volcanic ash, storm-ice) in a way that becomes a hall-story. Gain permanent **resistance** to one chosen environmental hazard (e.g. cold, storm, fire, sea).

Saga Scars Optionally, pair each Legendary Deed with a **Saga Scar**: a visible mark, habit, or quirk that signals the deed and may impose small costs (difficulty sleeping in calm weather, reflexive shielding behavior, faint frostbite, etc.). These are narrative prompts the GM can tag for SB spends.

27.7 Saga Decline & Fallen Heroes

Saga Reputation is not guaranteed. It can decline when your story curdles.

Loss Triggers

- **Oath-Breaking** — Publicly failing to keep a major oath, especially one bound before many witnesses or under shrine/Temple.
- **Cowardice** — Refusing to act when honor or duty clearly demands it, and others see this choice.
- **Betrayal** — Turning against guests, sworn allies, or those under your protection.
- **Hubris** — Actions that show dangerous overconfidence leading to tragic fallout (e.g. provoking needless war, squandering hard-won peace).

When one of these occurs in a public way, the GM may:

- Reduce Saga Reputation by 1 step (e.g. from 4 to 3).
- Strip one Saga Benefit (e.g. you no longer count as *Regional Champion*).
- Introduce a **Fallen Hero** Complication: former allies become rivals, children who idolized you turn bitter, or a skald begins composing a mocking counter-saga.

Redemption Arcs

Falling does not have to be the end:

- Create a **Redemption Saga** [6] timer. When it fills through self-sacrifice, amends, or impossible tasks, you may regain lost Saga steps or transform your legend into a new shape: *the Penitent*, *the Oath-Restorer*, etc.

27.8 Integration with Temple of Light & Shrines

Religious choice is part of your legend. Whether you stand with shrines, the Temple of Light, or both, the songs will say something about it.

Temple-Forward Sagas

- **Temple Conversion** — When the crew openly converts to the Temple of Light and champions its causes, they may earn Saga Points for:
 - Founding a new Temple or saving an existing one from ruin.
 - Ending a Faith Feud through Temple law and mercy.
 - Converting a powerful hall, jarl, or famed shrine-keeper.
- Mechanically, treat these as *Story-Shaping Decisions*. However, shrine-devout Audiences may assign negative tags (*Oath-Turners*, *Temple-Pawns*) and reduce certain Saga Benefits when dealing with traditionalists.

Shrine-Devout Sagas

- Crews who visibly champion shrines against Temple expansion may gain extra Saga Points for:
 - Restoring a desecrated shrine to power.
 - Driving out abusive Temple agents without collapsing law.
 - Crafting syncretic rites that keep old powers honored.
- Temple Audiences may see them as *heretics* or *obstinate pagans*, increasing DV or lowering starting Position in Temple courts.

Syncretic Sagas

- **Syncretic Path** — Some crews walk between: swearing shrine-oaths while bearing Temple blessings. Their Saga tends to be *contested*.
- Mechanically, they may earn Saga Points for brokering peace between faiths or inventing new shared rites, but:
 - Start certain faith scenes with **mixed Audience tags** (*Curious, Suspicious, Conflicted*).
 - The GM may tick **Dual Oath Conflict** or **Faith Feud** timers whenever a syncretic act goes badly.

Heretic Legends

Heretic Status If the crew openly defies Temple doctrine *and* shrine agreements (e.g. consorting with banned powers, profaning both altars), their Saga might shift into a darker mode:

- Temple and shrine both gain license to hunt them; enemies gain **+1d** to find religious allies.
- At the same time, desperate halls, outcasts, and hidden cults might invoke them as *necessary monsters* or *storm-bringers*, granting unusual aid.
- Treat them as *Legendary Adversaries* in some stories, *secret saints* in others; Position swings can be dramatic.

27.9 Using Saga at the Table

- **For Players:** Think of Saga as the camera pulling back. When you chase Saga Points, you are choosing which scenes become the ones future characters will hear about.
- **For GMs:** Use Saga Reputation to choose who has heard of the crew, who cares, and how strongly. Let it steer front creation, rival crews, and which NPCs show up asking for help or vengeance.

- **For the Campaign:** Over time, the Saga System can track the arc from unknown raiders to hall-builders, faith-champions, outcast heretics, or founders of a new order. Decide together which saga you are writing.

A Faith Tags for Linn Venues

B Glossary of Nordic Terms

B.1 Social and Political Terms

Aett A clan or family grouping, often tracing descent from a common ancestor. The basic social unit in Linn society.

Blood-silver Compensation paid to settle disputes and avoid feuds. A monetary or material payment that satisfies honor without violence.

Boast A public declaration of intended action, creating social obligation. Failure to fulfill a boast damages reputation and may start feuds.

Feud An ongoing conflict between families or crews, tracked mechanically. Allows for escalation and resolution through various means.

Lawspeaker Traditional role at Things who memorizes and recites the law. Could be incorporated as a specialized crew role.

Repute Social standing and honor within Linn society. Affects social interactions and access to opportunities.

Saga Epic tales of heroic deeds that enhance reputation. Also represents the mechanical system for tracking legendary status.

Skald A poet-singer who composes and performs verses about heroic deeds. Important for maintaining and spreading reputation.

String A favor, connection, or obligation that can be called upon. Represents social capital and relationships.

Thing Political assembly where laws are made, disputes settled, and oaths sworn. Winter gatherings for community decision-making.

Thinglet Smaller, informal assembly for local matters, often held within a hall.

Wyrd Fate or doom, often settled through ordeal or trial by combat when legal resolution fails.

Venue	Faith Tag	Mechanical Effect
A sea-stack shrine (Vélki)	Shrine Stronghold	Temple-devout charac- ters suffer 1 Position on faith actions
A Thing-ring (Hrævkn)	Shrine Stronghold	As above; also, any boast made here is wit- nessed (cannot be re- tracted)
A Temple chapel	Temple District	Shrine-devout charac- ters suffer 1 Position on faith actions
A synod court	Temple District	As above; also, any written testi- mony gains +1 die
A port town with both chapel and moot-ring	Mixed Quarter	No penalty; grand- standing by ei- ther extreme may trigger GM SB spend
A frontier village where a shrine and chapel face each other across a ford	Contested Ground	Both sides suffer 1 Position on faith

B.2 Maritime and Travel Terms

Beaching Hull Ship design feature allowing vessels to land directly on shore for easy access and escape.

Broadshore Cargo vessel type with higher freeboard and stouter construction, slower but more seaworthy than raiding ships.

Gare Local term for fog or mist conditions, particularly those affecting navigation and visibility.

Longhull Sleek raiding vessel with shallow draft and fast oars, designed for speed and beach landings.

Mistwise Specialized knowledge of navigating in foggy conditions, a valuable crew skill.

Pilot Stone Cairn or marker used for navigation in familiar waters, often moved to confuse rivals.

River-spear Light, narrow vessel designed for inland waterways, often with collapsible mast.

Shallow Draft Ship design allowing navigation in waters too shallow for deeper vessels.

Skerry Small rocky island or reef, often hazardous to navigation but useful for ambushes.

B.3 Cultural and Religious Terms

Hospitable Cultural value emphasizing the sacred duty to provide guest-right and proper hospitality.

Muster Spring gathering of crews and preparation for summer activities.

Oathbound Character committed to keeping vows and promises, regardless of cost.

Riverwise Specialized knowledge of river navigation, hazards, and local customs.

Shrine Warding Ritual protection of settlements or territories through sacred sites and ceremonies.

Wolf-Banner Warrior tradition or crew identity associated with fierce combat and boarding actions.

B.4 Seasonal Terms

Hearth Time Winter period of indoor activities, maintenance, and community bonding.

Muster Spring assembly for preparation and crew organization.

Raids Summer period of seaborne expeditions and military activities.

Settling Autumn period for resolving disputes, trade negotiations, and harvest activities.

Thing Season Winter period when assemblies are held due to weather and availability.

B.5 Combat and Conflict Terms

Board & Brace Naval combat action involving boarding enemy vessels and fighting hand-to-hand.

Wolf-Boarding Gear Specialized equipment for ship-to-ship combat, including hooks, ropes, and boarding planks.